

John de la Garza

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Systems Engineer with a passion for programming, discovery, and problem solving. I have worked on things from low-level code to distributed systems and everything in between.

Over the last year I have started using AI tools more frequently for large parts of the software development process. For example: RFCs, specifications, test plans, implementation. As well as debugging and root cause analysis for issues that span many systems.

SKILLS

- **domain:** Linux, distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, backend
- **language:** Python, Go, SQL, Rust, Bash, C, Perl, Lua, JavaScript, Ruby, Lisp
- **technology:** AWS, Kubernetes, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Nginx, Flask, WebSockets, SQLAlchemy, Netbox, FastAPI, Prometheus, Grafana, Django

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cloudflare, San Francisco, CA, Systems Engineer **6/2024 to 5/2026**

- SME for asset ingestion pipelines and Netbox as source of truth, owning plugins and integrations between the two systems.
- Led projects end to end: gathering requirements, writing RFCs, creating specs, test plans, documentation, code review, deployment, monitoring with Grafana, and follow-up
- Built a self-service UI component in the Netbox plugin enabling users to create hardware part-number to model-number mappings, eliminating manual spreadsheet-based ticket workflows.
- Automated server data ingestion with a Kubernetes cron job hitting a vendor API, using Pydantic models with strict validation and SQLAlchemy/PostgreSQL constraints before pushing into Netbox via the asset ingestion pipeline, saving colleagues from manual processing.
- Built a two-stage reconciliation pipeline: detect diffs between device-reported state (collected via Kafka from node agents) and Netbox, then auto-resolve approved fields in Netbox per RFC-defined rules.
- Wrote test coverage for all new code and refactored existing code in the Netbox plugin and HAWAI ingestion pipeline, reducing mocking overhead and improving test execution speed.
- Triaged provisioning issues and Airflow DAG failures, performing root cause analysis and routing to the appropriate team for resolution.
- Used AI-assisted development tools (opencode) to direct AI coding agents for feature implementation, code review, test generation, and refactoring, accelerating development velocity across the asset management platform.

Blackberry, Irvine, CA, Senior Software Engineer **4/2019 to 9/2023**

- Led design and development of a REST API backend for an enterprise security product, spanning feature work, bug fixes, deployments, and operations. Development was done mostly in Go and Python.
- First responder for customer-facing incidents, tracking root causes across distributed services and deploying fixes.
- Frequently pair programmed with others that were newer to the job to get them up to speed on using git consistently and learning how to run/develop/debug the different microservices.
- Transitioned several services from Python to Go.
- Used OpenResty/Lua to build a bidirectional WebSocket gateway routing messages between customer devices, Kinesis streams, and internal HTTP microservices via pub/sub.

Comscore, Portland, OR, Senior Software Engineer 11/2016 to 12/2018

- Worked on a distributed system that counted watched ads and determined who watched them, handling data ingestion, normalization, summarization, and export pipelines.
- Built composable command-line tools that acted as a query language for analyzing incoming data and generating custom reports.

Idealist.org, Portland, OR, Senior Developer 7/2015 to 7/2016

- Worked on a team creating a REST API that needed to inter-operate with an existing model, database, and messaging system. It provided HTTPS endpoints to allow other systems to post jobs in an automated fashion. This involved doing a deep dive into the code to fully understand the existing architecture.
- Created a new system that allowed customers to bulk post job listings. It was available to the end users as a REST API where they could submit jobs, check status, etc. It was consistent, well-documented, and designed to be discoverable.
- Wrote shell scripts to create a chroot-based sandbox. This provided a reproducible development environment on individual developer computers.

Rally, Washington, DC, Operations Engineer 6/2014 to 3/2015

- Implemented a git-backed HTTP configuration system using Chef on AWS that auto-published on push, eliminating manual file distribution.
- Created a cron job that pulled down XML data, processed them, and inserted them into a local database.

TVplus, Orange, CA, Senior Developer 8/2012 to 1/2014

- Designed and implemented a read/write caching layer for a REST API which was used by a JavaScript front end.
- Designed and implemented a system to daily download XML data that represented TV program schedules for the next two weeks and merge/load them into a local database. This could mean scheduled shows were removed, added, or rescheduled, flagging disassociated content for human review.
- Created a service to edit video files (mute segments, transcode to H.264/AAC) and upload hashes to an audio-matching service, with processing parallelized across multiple cores.
- Set up an LXC-based development environment on a single server to replicate a multi-node AWS production stack.

EDUCATION

Cal State Fullerton, BA Management Information Systems, Dean's List

SPOKEN LANGUAGES

English and Spanish